

Prototypes

Facebook Prototypes is something like Google Labs. It allows you to access and use some experimental applications – or 'product experiments' – to check out if they're popular or if they work at all

Voice Chat

Vivox – the Boston based company that gave integrated voice chat to Second Life is all set to roll out high quality voice chat services in Facebook

Mafia Wars: This is a multi-player browser game that's on MySpace and Tagged as well but has an incredible 23,367,984 monthly active users (and growing) on Facebook alone. This is another hit game by Zynga, but unlike the slow, domestic space of Farmville, it encourages you to loot, rob, kill and create an Al Capone like empire. Set in New York City, Little Italy or Cub, players must choose a character, do jobs to earn cash, build a gang by recruiting members and fight other mafia conglomerates – all with limited stamina, energy and health

As in Farmville, you can 'level up' by getting more points and gaining XP by doing more jobs. As you rise up in levels, you are rewarded with access to new features, new weapons and new jobs.

MindJolt Games: More than 50 games clamour for your attention on the MindJolt Games application. Prevent balls from reaching the bottom, break up brick walls, play pool, destroy balls in combinations of three – there are innumerable options to choose from.

If you get bored of getting shot up in Mafia Wars, turn to MindJolt for several hours of unlimited gaming pleasure.



Every character has its own speciality

There are other funky hangout games like Yoville and Living Social, which let you interact with friends and contacts in entertaining ways. Don't forget to check out Pet Society, another game application that contains plenty of games and decorations to play around with.

Utilities

Here's a list of some useful application in Facebook:

NewsCloud: This is a social news application which allows you to discuss socially relevant issues, aimed at gaining solidarity for particular endeavours and movements. You can vote, read, submit or comment on stories right from your Facebook account. Every story you post earns 10 points, a vote gets you 5 points and sharing a story or inviting a friend gets you 25 points each. Newsfeeds

are a part of this application. You can also access videos from reliable news sources here.

App Builder: About 5,00,000 people have used this one. This is the most interactive application on Facebook

which gives every user a chance to feel like genius. If you've got a great idea and you think people will like it, just transform it into an application, sit back and watch how you can change the world using Facebook.

Files: This is a storage service from Box.net that allows you to upload and store files directly from their profile. Although it's just 1 GB and doesn't even compare with remote storage facilities like MSN's Skydrive, this is useful if you want to display these files on your profile. Friends can then download these files. This is really easy to use, but these files are visible to all your Facebook friends and you may not really want everyone to see them.

Pixlr Editor: Pixlr is a free, Firefox-powered online photo editor. Whether you want to upload new photos or edit older ones, Pixlr is an excellent application to help you through the process. Anyone who's accustomed to Photoshop or Paintshop will find the interface smooth sailing. Alternatively, you could use the Pixlr Express to crop, resize and juggle photos around with ease.

DandyID: With accounts on services such as Twitter, Flickr and MySpace, and more or less the same set of friends on the list – and you're getting bugged with the repeated logins and updates. DandyID has the answer to your woes.

This is an application that will synch all your accounts and display them on your Facebook profile.

Positive Thoughts: Send a positive thought to each of your friends every morning using the Positive Thoughts application and make their day. While not all of them are in English, they're all deep, philosophical, bright and cheery. Try it out and get cheered up yourself when your Facebook friends write in to thank you.

Business

Social networking gives you access to all your contacts. Although not comprehensive, here's a list of business applications on Facebook that can fire up your business and ensure better brand recall without the prohibitive expenses of an advertising campaign.

Promotions: Facebook Fan Pages are full of potential customers who stay online for prolonged periods on the site discussing everything about their favourites. Any agency or company could cash in on this by putting their advertisements on the fan page.

Promotions for Fan Pages lets you do just that. You could use it to create and launch marketing campaigns in a few minutes using the simple, user-friendly interface of this application. These must be interactive and in the nature of lotteries, contests, coupons and discount tickets. Lately, Facebook has begun to scrutinise these – especially the promo-quizzier – and are set on shutting any agencies that appear to abuse this feature.

Tag Biz Pro Business Cards: Use Tag Biz Pro to create a life-like business card form a whole range of features to set up a business network on Facebook. You can attach your business 'card' to all your



Crazy Taxi is one of the fun apps on MindJolt

